

Habilidades Comunicativas en Lengua Extranjera
Profesional (Inglés)

Unit 5. Job search

Index

Schema

Key Ideas

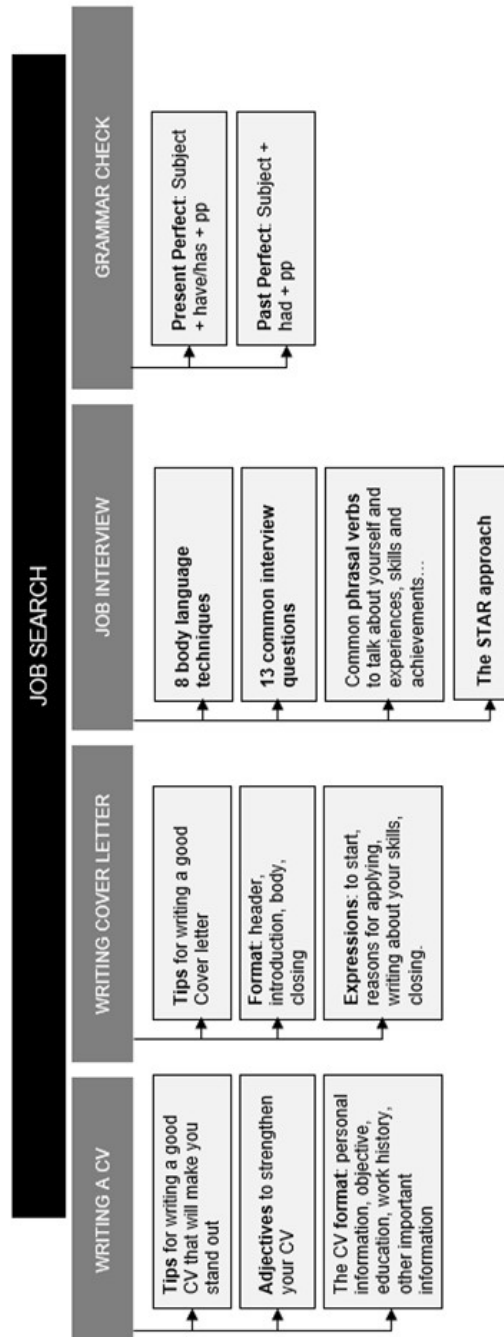
- 5.1. Introduction and Objectives
- 5.2. Writing a CV
- 5.3. Writing a Cover letter
- 5.4. Preparing for a Job Interview
- 5.5. Grammar check
- 5.6. Bibliographical references

In Depth

- How to deal with complaints effectively
- 3 steps to getting what you want in a negotiation

Trainings

- Training 1. Dealing with complaints
- Training 2. Dealing with complaints
- Training 3. Negotiations
- Training 4. Negotiation dialogue
- Training 5. Conditional tenses.



5.1. Introduction and Objectives

A successful job search requires careful preparation and effective communication. Crafting a **well-structured CV and Cover letter** is essential for making a strong first impression on potential employers. Additionally, preparing for **job interviews** with clear and confident answers increases the chances of securing a position. Understanding the appropriate language, tone and structure enhances credibility and professionalism. In this unit, we will also reinforce the use of **present perfect and past perfect tenses**, essential for describing experiences, achievements, and career progression accurately.

- ▶ **Objective 1:** Learn how to structure and formal a CV effectively, using key vocabulary to highlight professional skills and experience.
- ▶ **Objective 2:** Develop the ability to write a professional Cover letter, using appropriate structure, tone and key phrases.
- ▶ **Objective 3:** Enhance interview skills by practicing responses to common questions and learning strategies for confident and effective communication.
- ▶ **Objective 4:** Apply present perfect and past perfect tenses in job applications and interviews to describe work experience and achievements accurately.

5.2. Writing a CV

Tips for writing a good CV

Preparing a good CV is essential for being successful in your employment search. It is important to take time and care in developing a CV that will make you stand out.

A proper CV gives in-depth and structured information about the professional experience and qualifications of a person. Keep it brief! Keep your documents short and to the point.

- ▶ Prepare several CVs, each tailored to a different target job or field.
- ▶ Length: your CV should not exceed two pages. Keep your CV short and to the point.
- ▶ Prioritise your CV content. Your most important experience should be listed first.
- ▶ Keywords: include keywords to draw the reader's attention to specific attributes of your profile.
- ▶ Use descriptive adjectives and verbs to make your CV stand out.

Adjectives to strengthen your CV

- ▶ **Determined:** determinado
- ▶ **Hard-working:** trabajador
- ▶ **Diligent:** diligente
- ▶ **Trustworthy:** digno de confianza
- ▶ **Team-player:** colaborador
- ▶ **Motivated:** motivado
- ▶ **Reliable:** fiable

- ▶ **Self-starter:** emprendedor
- ▶ **Persistent:** persistente
- ▶ **Dynamic:** dinámico
- ▶ **Organized:** organizado
- ▶ **Professional:** profesional
- ▶ **Passionate:** entusiasta

How to make a resume that will make you stand out

In today's competitive job market, crafting a compelling CV is more important than ever. CV trends have evolved significantly, and **recruiters now spend less than 10 seconds** scanning a CV before deciding whether to continue reading. To make an impact, job seekers must adapt to modern hiring practices and optimise their resumes for both human recruiters and **AI-driven applicant tracking systems**.

- ▶ **Keep it concise and impactful:** lengthy objectives statements are no longer a thing. Instead, concise **headlines** that summarize your key qualifications and career highlights are now preferred.
- ▶ **Use bullet points to highlight achievements:** a well-structured CV should focus on **achievements**, **skills** and **responsibilities** using **bullet points** rather than dense paragraphs.
- ▶ **Include all relevant experience:** **internships, volunteer work, freelance projects and extracurricular activities** are valuable additions that showcase skills such as leadership, teamwork and initiative.

- **Optimise for AI Screening Systems** : many companies now use AI to filter resumes before they even reach a recruiter. To ensure your CV passes through these systems, incorporate **industry-specific keywords from the job description**. Formatting also plays a role, **avoid complex designs, excessive graphics or unusual fonts that may not be read correctly by ATS**.

How to write a resume that stands out

In the In Depth section, you can find a very interesting video on how to write a resume that will make you stands out, advices from a hiring manager.

The CV Format

Personal information	Objective	Education
Include your full name, mailing address, phone number, email address Álvaro Fernández E-mail: alvaro.fernandez@gmail.com Av. Diagonal 25, 08019, Barcelona, Spain Mobile: +34 697 183 182	It helps the reader quickly to see who you are and what you're looking for. "A reliable and hard-working team player with three years of experience in the computer sales field. I have excellent interpersonal and communication skills. I seek a challenging opportunity for growth within the IT sales field."	Terminology for education can't always be directly translated because often the type of education differs from country to country.

Figure 1. CV Format part 1. Source: author original.

SPANISH	UK ENGLISH	AMERICAN ENGLISH
Educación Primaria y Educación Secundaria Obligatoria	Primary School	Elementary School & Middle School / Junior High
Formación Profesional	Vocational school	Vocational College or Career College
Bachillerato	A-Levels	High School
Selectividad	Exams	S.A.T. Exams
Grado	Bachelor's degree	Bachelor's degree
Máster	Master's degree	Master's
Doctorado	Ph. D.	Ph. D.

Figure 2. Education terminology. Source: author original.

Employment background	No work experience?	Additional information
It can also be called "Work experience", "Work history" or "Employment history". You should include the names and locations of the companies you worked for, the positions, employment dates and the duties you performed.	You can compensate by emphasizing other experiences and relevant skills. Be sure to include any internships or volunteer work.."	Language skills: be honest! Conversational Fluent Proficient Native Computer skills For ex: Comfortable with MS Office Suit (Word, Excel and PowerPoint), Internet and email proficient.

Figure 3. CV Format part 2. Source: author original.

Employment background

June 2011–June 2020: BBVA Bank, Madrid, Spain

Lending officer

- Exceeded business lending target figures by 35% in 2012.
 - Significantly improved profitability on bank branch lending portfolio.
 - Built and maintained key business relationships with several high-value collaborators.
-

Figure 4. Employment background structure. Source: author original.

5.3. Writing a Cover letter

Tips for writing a Cover letter

A cover letter is an important tool for you as a job seeker as it allows you to creatively describe yourself and indicate how you would be perfect for the vacant job.

Your cover letter is your first and best chance to make a good impression. It should be **tailored** specifically to the job you're applying for and contain **adjectives** and **descriptive words** to relate your **skills** and **experience** to the job

Format

Your Cover letter should be one page in length and is generally formatted as follows:

► Header

The header is the section where you include **your own address** as well as the **recipient's contact information** and the **date**. After the name of the addressee, it is appropriate to use a **comma** (,). Immediately above the addressee, you may include a line indicating the **purpose** of the letter.

► Introduction

The introduction should be a **short paragraph** to catch the attention of the reader and **state your intentions**. In this section, include information on **why you are writing**. Mention the **position** you are applying for and **where you found the job listing**. Include the name of a **mutual** contact if you have one.

► Body

The body of the cover letter is to **highlight** your qualifications and **suitability** for the job. In this section, include your **skills**, **academic** and **practical qualifications** and past **experiences**. Other key information such as **licenses** or **availability** for work can be included here as well.

Remember: you are interpreting your CV, not repeating it.

► Closing

Here, you **summarise** your letter and **emphasise** your suitability for the position. **Thank** the employer for considering you for the position. End with a closing such as “**Sincerely**,” or “**Yours truly**”, followed by your handwritten **signature** if possible.

Expressions

To start the cover letter	• I noticed with interest your advertisement for ... • I am writing in response to your advertisement posted on... • I am very interested in applying for the position of ... • I am applying for the position of, which was advertised in • I was interested to see your advertisement for ... • I was referred to you by .../name/, who informed me of a .../position/ • I have pleasure in applying for the advertised position, as ... • Please accept this letter as my application for the position of...
----------------------------------	--

Figure 5. Expressions to start the cover letter. Source: author original.

Reasons for applying for the job	• I would be well suited to the position because ... • I have a lively interest in ... and would appreciate the opportunity to work with you. • As you can see from my enclosed résumé, my experience and qualifications match this position's requirements. • My strengths are ... • I believe the combination of my education and experiences have prepared me... • It is a challenging position for which I believe I am well qualified. • This position represents an opportunity to continue my committed career path...
---	---

Figure 6. Expressions. Giving reasons for applying for the job. Source: author original.

Writing about your skills	• I have a working knowledge of ... • I believe I possess the right combination of ... • I am an experienced user of ... • My professional experiences are supplemented by... • My interest and knowledge in this area was further enhanced by... • My area of effectiveness is... • I have an excellent command of ...
----------------------------------	---

Figure 7. Expressions. Writing about your skills. Source: author original.

Closing	• I would appreciate the chance to meet with you to discuss ... • I look forward to our meeting. • If you are interested, please contact me at ... • I am eager to talk with you about the contribution I could make to your firm. • Thanking you most sincerely for your time and consideration. • Thank you for considering me for this very important position. • I look forward with enthusiasm to an opportunity for an interview.
----------------	--

Figure 8. Expressions. Closing. Source: author original.

5.4. Preparing for a Job Interview

Warm-up questions

- ▶ What kind of questions do you find easier to answer: behavioural or technical/job-specific? Why?
- ▶ What are your least favourite interview questions?
- ▶ What do you think about unusual interview questions (e.g. 'If you could compare yourself with any animal...')?
- ▶ What are the advantages of online interviews?

Body language techniques

8 body language techniques

In the In Depth section, you can find a very interesting video about 8 body language techniques that could be helpful for you during job interviews.

- ▶ **Maintain positive eye contact:** it tells them that you are a confident person.
- ▶ **Sit upright in the interview chair:** it tells that you're professional and able to pay attention, TIP: place your hands on top of your knees to stay calm.
- ▶ **Use your hands** periodically during the interview to accentuate a specific point: to look positive and enthusiastic.
- ▶ **Avoid touching your face during the interview:** it looks like you are distracted and unable to sit still.
- ▶ **Make sure you smile:** they will always smile back. employers want to hire someone positive.

- ▶ **Make sure you listen:** it shows that you are involved in the process. demonstrate that you are listening with face gestures.
- ▶ **Use your head while responding:** keep your head perfectly straight and look to the eyes (if you want to seem confident) or keep your head to the side (if you want to express understanding of a situation or seem sympathetic).
- ▶ **Make sure you dress to impress:** dress smart

Common interview questions

- ▶ Why did you choose to study your degree subject?

Focus on your **genuine interests**, and **highlight how they align with your career goals**. Mention how the degree matched your motivations, skills and competences.

Example: “I chose to study [degree subject] because I’ve always been fascinated by [specific aspect] and saw it as a foundation for pursuing a career in [specific industry]”.

- ▶ Tell me something about yourself.

Keep it professional, focusing on relevant aspects of your **background** and **experience**. Talk about some of your **biggest achievements** and your main **skills**.

Example: “I have a degree in X, and X years of experience in X”.

“I like challenges, solving problems and coming up with solutions”.

“I am a very creative thinker, I have an open mind and like to explore alternative solutions to problems”.

“I’m very organised in both my personal and professional life. I think this is a good trait since it enables me to be very productive in the job”.

- ▶ Why do you want this job?

Highlight how the job aligns your skills, interests and career goals.

“I’m excited about this role because it allows me to leverage my skills while working on challenging projects. I’m particularly drawn to your company’s mission and values (mention them) and I believe my experience aligns well with the requirements of the position”.

- ▶ Why should we hire you?

Emphasize your unique strengths and how they will benefit the company.

“You should hire me because I bring a combination of [specific skills], a proven track record in [relevant achievements], and a passion for [industry]. I am confident in my ability to contribute to the team and help achieve the company’s goals”.

- ▶ What will you do if you don’t get this job?

Never say that you will do nothing. Mention that you will work on **personal projects** that will allow you to continue learning, that you will do **voluntary work** or **courses** to further your education, or that you will study languages to improve your skills. Demonstrate resilience and a positive attitude.

“While I am enthusiastic about the opportunity here, if I don’t get this job, I will continue to explore similar roles in the industry. I believe every experience contributes to personal and professional growth” // “Although I am very interested in working here, if I don’t succeed I think it would be a good opportunity to work on personal projects and improve my language skills with other languages”.

- ▶ What are your strengths/weaknesses?

Strength: name some of your main strengths and focus on one of them. It is always good to give an example and that some of these strengths are the ones that companies have talked about in the job offer.

“One of my key strengths is my ability to [x], which has been pivotal in [x]”.

Weakness: consider how you can turn a weakness into a strength. For example: “I am quite reserved and like to take my time in making important decisions. On the other hand, this trait has prevented me from rushing into decisions that could be detrimental to the company”. // “I used to struggle with [x], but I’ve taken steps to improve by [mention steps taken or skills developed]”.

- ▶ What do you know about our company?

Conduct thorough research on the company's history, values, products/services, and recent news.

“I’ve researched this company extensively and I am impressed by its commitment to [mention a specific value]. I also noticed your recent [achievement], which further solidified my interest in joining the team”.

- ▶ How do you typically approach new projects?

Describe your systematic approach, including research, planning and collaboration.

“When facing a new project, I start by researching the objectives and requirements. I then create a detailed plan, allocate tasks based on team member’s strengths, and maintain open communication throughout the project to ensure its success”.

- ▶ How do you handle stress?

Talk about **healthy coping mechanisms** and how you **prioritize** tasks to manage workload.

“I manage stress by prioritizing tasks, breaking down projects into manageable steps, and maintaining open communication with my team. Additionally, I practice [mention a stress-relief technique] to ensure I stay focused and effective during challenging times”.

- ▶ Why did you leave your last job?

Keep it positive and focus on **seeking new challenges or opportunities for growth. Never speak badly about your superiors.** Try to make your answers have to do with the fact that you were looking for **more opportunities for growth, more responsibilities...**

“I found myself not challenged enough with the work, because I felt there was a lack of room for growth”.

“I am looking for a new challenge and an opportunity to use my skills and experience”

“I am seeking a position with a stable company with room for growth and opportunity for advancement”.

“This position seemed like an excellent match for my skills and experience, which I wasn’t able to fully utilize in my last job”

- ▶ How do you work in a team?

Emphasize **collaboration**, **communication** and your ability to **contribute** to a team's success.

"I believe in open communication and collaboration within a team. I actively listen to my teammates, share my insights, and value diverse perspectives. I am adaptable, supportive and always willing to take on tasks that contribute to the team's overall success".

- ▶ Where do you see yourself in five years' time?

Align your answer with the company's growth and your career goals.

"In five years, I see myself in a more advanced role where I can contribute to [specific company initiatives] and take on increased responsibilities. I'm committed to continuous learning and development, and I believe that by then, I'll have honed my skills to make a significant impact in a leadership position within the company."

- ▶ Do you have any questions you would like to ask us?

Always have a question prepared for the interviewer, as this shows interest in the offer.

"Can you share more details about the team I would be working with?" (This question shows your interest in your potential colleagues and how you might fit into the existing team).

"What are the main challenges or priorities the team is currently facing?" (This question shows your proactive attitude to contribute to overcoming challenges).

Common phrasal verbs

- ▶ When talking about yourself and your experience
 - **Take on**: accept responsibilities or a role. "In my previous job, I took on the role of team leader, which helped me develop my leadership skills."
 - **Carry out**: perform or complete a task. "I have carried out several projects related to digital marketing and data analysis."
 - **Work on**: put effort into improving something. "I'm currently working on improving my public speaking skills."
 - **Be in charge of**: be responsible for something. "I was in charge of training new employees and managing schedules."
- ▶ Describing skills and achievements
 - **Come up with**: think of an idea or solution. "I came up with a new strategy to increase customer engagement."
 - **Figure out**: find a solution to a problem. "I had to figure out a way to reduce costs without affecting productivity."
 - **Bring in**: introduce or attract. "I brought in new clients by improving our social media presence."
 - **Keep up with**: stay updated. "I always keep up with the latest industry trends to stay competitive."

The STAR approach

The STAR approach is a structured method for answering behavioural interview questions. Using the STAR approach helps you provide relevant information and demonstrate your skills and abilities through real-life examples. It also allows the interviewer to assess your problem-solving skills, decision-making abilities, and whether you're a good fit for the role based on examples from your past experiences.

STAR stands for:

- ▶ **Situation:** describe the context or background of the situation you were in
- ▶ **Task:** explain the specific task or goal you were responsible for within that situation
- ▶ **Action:** talk about the actions you took to deal with the situation and complete the task
- ▶ **Result:** share the outcome of your actions

For example, for the question “Can you tell me about a recent challenge you’ve faced?”. A possible answer could be:

“(**Situation**) In my previous role, we encountered a significant decrease in customer satisfaction ratings. (**Task**) My responsibility was to investigate the root causes of this decline and implement strategies to improve satisfaction levels. (**Action**) I conducted multiple customer surveys, analyzed feedback data, and identified key areas for improvement. (**Result**) Because of our efforts, we successfully implemented improvements, leading to a noticeable increase in customer satisfaction ratings”.

5.5. Grammar check

Present perfect

PRESENT PERFECT		
We use Present Perfect to talk about: • Experiences in our life (we don't say when) • Recent actions • Life achievements, or things that have just happened		
AFF	NEG	INT
I/You/We/You/They + have + past participle (I have eaten)	I/You/We/You/They + haven't + past participle (You haven't eaten)	Have + I/You/We/You/They + pp? (Have they eaten?)
She/He/It + has + past participle (He has tried)	He/She/It + hasn't + pp (She hasn't tried)	Has + he/she/it + pp? (Has he tried?)

Image 1. Present perfect. Source: author original.

Examples:

- ▶ I have visited London.
- ▶ We have never flown on a plane.
- ▶ Have you ever ridden a horse?

Past perfect

PAST PERFECT		
We use Past Perfect when we talk about two actions in the past, and want to show that one happened before the other.		
AFF	NEG	INT
Subject + had + pp (I had finished / he had studied)	Subject + hadn't + pp (I hadn't finished / he hadn't studied)	Had + subject + pp? (Had you finished? / Had he studied?)

Image 2. Past Perfect. Source: author original.

Examples:

- ▶ I had finished dinner before the movie started.
- ▶ He hadn't done his homework, so the teacher was angry.
- ▶ Had you ever seen that place before yesterday?

5.6. Bibliographical references

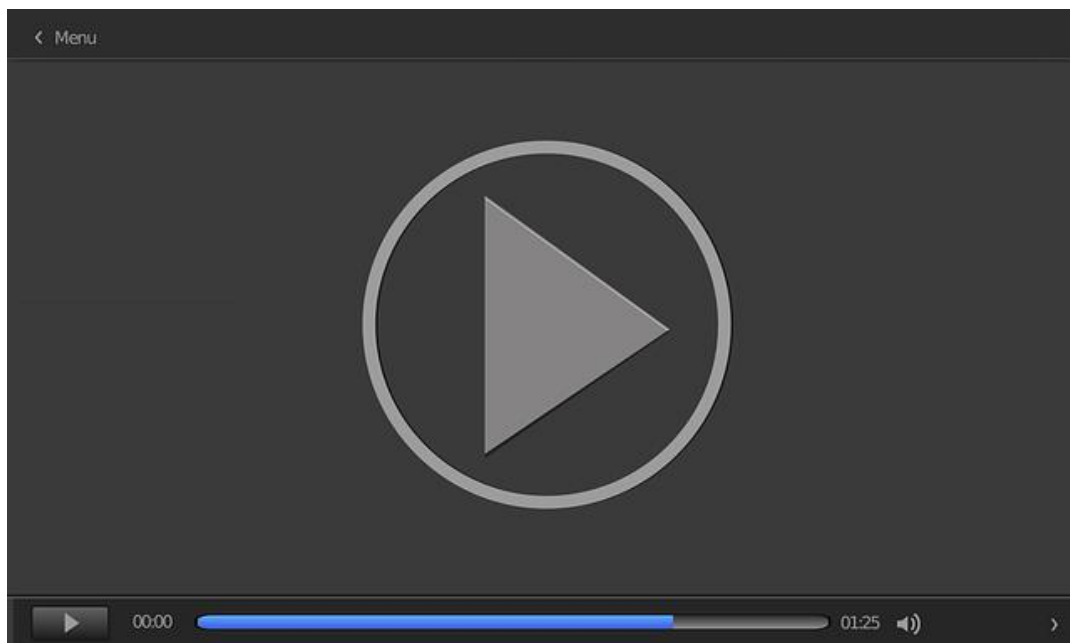
Murphy, R. (2022). *English Grammar in Use* (6th ed.). Cambridge University Press.

Vaughan, A., & Zemach, D. (2020). *Writing for the Workplace: Business Communication for Professionals*. Oxford University Press.

How to deal with complaints effectively

Skillsoft YouTube. (2018, 21 agosto). *Handling customer complaints: defusing frustration* [Video]. YouTube. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WphIXqTp_es

This is a very interesting video on how to deal with complaints effectively. It gives you important tips and information on how to handle complaints in the best way possible.



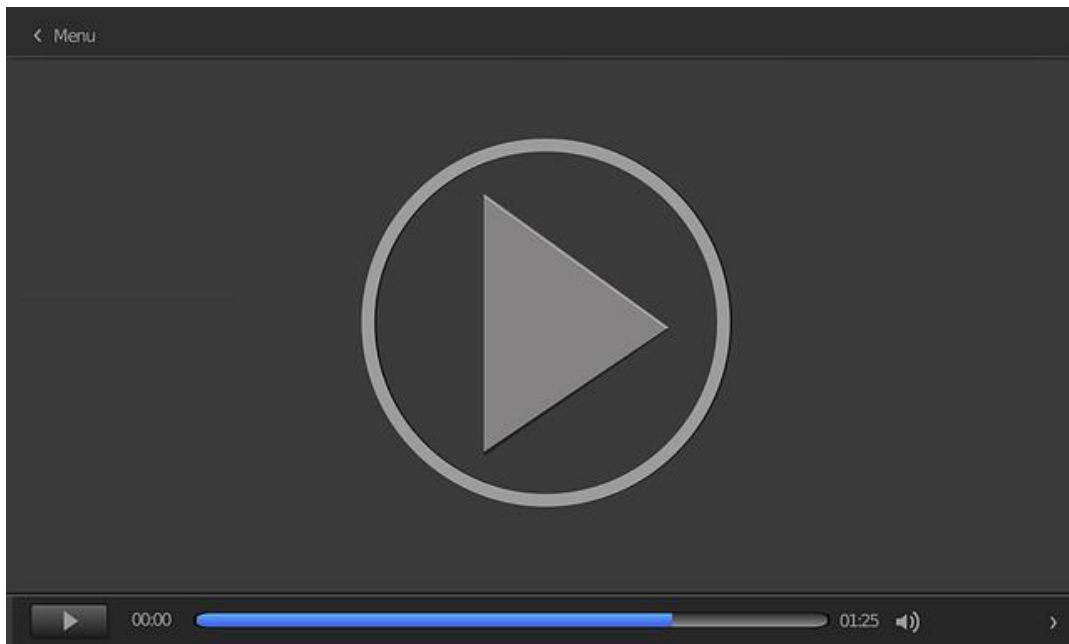
Accede al vídeo:

https://www.youtube.com/embed/WphIXqTp_es

3 steps to getting what you want in a negotiation

TED. (2021, 15 noviembre). *3 steps to getting what you want in a negotiation | The Way We Work, a TED series* [Video]. YouTube. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z3HJCQJ2Lmo>

This is a very interesting video about three steps to getting what you want in a negotiation. Negotiation is not about dominating, but about crafting a relationship.



Accede al vídeo:

<https://www.youtube.com/embed/Z3HJCQJ2Lmo>

Training 1. Dealing with complaints

Listen to four dialogues and complete the chart with your own words. Which complaint did you hear in each dialogue? What action was decided on in each dialogue? You can play the audio here: <https://www.linguahouse.com/esl-lesson-plans/business-english/complaining-and-apologizing/audioplayer/complaining-and-apologizing-ex2>

	COMPLAINT	SOLUTION
Dialogue 1		
Dialogue 2		
Dialogue 3		
Dialogue 4		

Solution 1

	COMPLAINT	SOLUTION
Dialogue 1	They have a problem with their latest delivery. It arrived three days late again and this is the 10 th time happening.	The driver was delayed at the border. The woman promised to look into the matter and do what she can to make sure it doesn't happen again.
Dialogue 2	There's a problem with the order. The casing on the television sets are cracked.	It must be due to bad-handling. The woman asked to send the goods back to give them replacements, plus a discount on the next order.
Dialogue 3	There's a mistake on their invoice. They were overcharged by 50 pounds.	Subtract the extra amount for the next invoice.
Dialogue 4	Lack of customer service to help her choose a laptop.	They're rather short-staffed at the moment. The man asked her to wait there until he finds someone to help her.

Training 2. Dealing with complaints

Listen to the audio again and complete the sentences. You can listen to the audio twice again.

- ▶ 1. I'm a____ we have a p____ w____ your latest delivery.
- ▶ 2. I'm very s____ about that. I'm afraid our diver was d____ at the border.
- ▶ 3. Leave it w____ me. I will l____ into the matter.
- ▶ 4. I'm c____ because we have a problem with our order.
- ▶ 5. What s____ to be the problem?
- ▶ 6. In what w____ are they d____?
- ▶ 7. I'm very sorry. This has never h____ before. It must be d____ to bad handling.
- ▶ 8. If you s____ us back the d____ sets, we'll send you r____ immediately and give you a d____ on your next order.
- ▶ 9. I a____ again for any i____ caused.
- ▶ 10. I'm calling about a m____ on our i____. It looks like you have o____ us by 50 pounds.
- ▶ 11. I'm sorry about this. Our accounts department m____ h____ made a small mistake when they processed your order.
- ▶ 12. We'll i____ a corrected invoice immediately.
- ▶ 13. I'm very sorry madam, we are rather s____ - ____ at the moment.
- ▶ 14. Please w____ here and I'll f____ someone to help you.

Solution 2

- ▶ 1. I'm **afraid** we have a **problem with** your latest delivery.
- ▶ 2. I'm very **sorry** about that. I'm afraid our diver was **delayed** at the border.
- ▶ 3. Leave it **with** me. I will **look** into the matter.
- ▶ 4. I'm **calling** because we have a problem with our order.
- ▶ 5. What **seems** to be the problem?
- ▶ 6. In what **way** are they **damaged**?
- ▶ 7. I'm very sorry. This has never **happened** before. It must be **due** to bad handling.
- ▶ 8. If you **send** us back the **damaged** sets, we'll send you **replacements** immediately and give you a **discount** on your next order.
- ▶ 9. I **apologise** again for any **inconvenience** caused.
- ▶ 10. I'm calling about a **mistake** on our **invoice** It looks like you have **overcharged** us by 50 pounds.
- ▶ 11. I'm sorry about this. Our accounts department **must have** made a small mistake when they processed your order.
- ▶ 12. We'll **issue** a corrected invoice immediately.
- ▶ 13. I'm very sorry madam, we are rather **short-staffed** at the moment.
- ▶ 14. Please **wait** here and I'll **find** someone to help you.

Training 3. Negotiations

Fill in the gaps with the vocabulary from the box about negotiations.

Agree – deal – flexibility – for – halfway – make – manage – mind – prepared –
reasonable – room – get – throw – work

- ▶ 1. So, shall we _____ down to business, then.
- ▶ 2. We were looking to _____ an order for 100 cases.
- ▶ 3. What sort of price did you have in _____?
- ▶ 4. We were hoping _____ a unit price of around \$4,50.
- ▶ 5. Would you be willing to meet us _____?
- ▶ 6. If you cut your delivery time by, say, 10 days, we should be _____ to pay the price you have proposed.
- ▶ 7. We'd need to see a bit more _____ on terms of payment.
- ▶ 8. Come on, let's be _____ here.
- ▶ 9. Unfortunately, I don't have any more _____ to negotiate this fee.
- ▶ 10. I suppose we could _____ that.
- ▶ 11. I think we could _____ something out here.
- ▶ 12. I think we could _____ on 3 weeks.
- ▶ 13. Sure, we can _____ that in.
- ▶ 14. Ok, it's a _____.

Solution 3

- ▶ 1. So, shall we **get** down to business, then.
- ▶ 2. We were looking to **make** an order for 100 cases.
- ▶ 3. What sort of price did you have in **mind**?
- ▶ 4. We were hoping **for** a unit price of around \$4,50.
- ▶ 5. Would you be willing to meet us **halfway**?
- ▶ 6. If you cut your delivery time by, say, 10 days, we should be **prepared** to pay the price you have proposed.
- ▶ 7. We'd need to see a bit more **flexibility** on terms of payment.
- ▶ 8. Come on, let's be **reasonable** here.
- ▶ 9. Unfortunately, I don't have any more **room** to negotiate this fee.
- ▶ 10. I suppose we could **manage** that.
- ▶ 11. I think we could **work** something out here.
- ▶ 12. I think we could **agree** on 3 weeks.
- ▶ 13. Sure, we can **throw** that in.
- ▶ 14. Ok, it's a **deal**.

Training 4. Negotiation dialogue

Fill in the gaps with the words and expressions from the box.

make – flexibility – mind – halfway – agree – get – for – reasonable – stalemate – deal

TechSolutions (T): So, shall we _____ (1) down to business, then?

Innovatech (I): Sure. We were looking to _____ (2) an order for 200 software licenses.

T: What sort of price did you have in _____ (3)?

I: We were hoping _____ (4) a unit price of around \$50 per license.

T: Hmm, that might be difficult. Would you be willing to meet us _____ (5) at \$60?

I: If you include a one-year technical support package, we should be able to accept that price.

T: That seems _____ (6). However, we'd need to see a bit more _____ (7) on the payment terms.

I: I understand. Unfortunately, I don't have any more room to negotiate on the support fees.

T: Alright, let's not reach a _____ (8) over this. How about we add a 6-month support extension instead?

I: That sounds good. I think we could _____ (9) on that.

T: Great. So, to clarify, we agree on 200 licenses at \$60 each, with 1-year support plus a 6-month extension.

I: Yes, that all sounds fine.

T: Ok, it's a _____ (10)!

Solution 4

TechSolutions (T): So, shall we **get** (1) down to business, then?

Innovatech (I): Sure. We were looking to **make** (2) an order for 200 software licenses.

T: What sort of price did you have in **mind** (3)?

I: We were hoping **for** (4) a unit price of around \$50 per license.

T: Hmm, that might be difficult. Would you be willing to meet us **halfway** (5) at \$60?

I: If you include a one-year technical support package, we should be able to accept that price.

T: That seems **reasonable** (6). However, we'd need to see a bit more **flexibility** (7) on the payment terms.

I: I understand. Unfortunately, I don't have any more room to negotiate on the support fees.

T: Alright, let's not reach a **stalemate** (8) over this. How about we add a 6-month support extension instead?

I: That sounds good. I think we could **agree** (9) on that.

T: Great. So, to clarify, we agree on 200 licenses at \$60 each, with 1-year support plus a 6-month extension.

I: Yes, that all sounds fine.

T: Ok, it's a **deal** (10)!

Training 5. Conditional tenses.

Complete the sentences with the correct form of the verbs in brackets, depending on the type of conditional tense you need to use.

- ▶ 1. If you _____ (heat) water to 100°C, it _____ (boil). (Zero conditional).
- ▶ 2. If she _____ (study) harder, she _____ (pass) the exam. (First conditional).
- ▶ 3. If we _____ (leave) earlier, we _____ (not miss) the train. (Third conditional).
- ▶ 4. If she _____ (wake up) on time, she _____ (not be) late for the meeting (Third conditional).
- ▶ 5. If you _____ (press) this button, the machine _____ (start). (Zero conditional).
- ▶ 6. If we _____ (not hurry), we _____ (miss) the bus. (First conditional).
- ▶ 7. If I _____ (know) his number, I _____ (call) him. (Second conditional).
- ▶ 8. If he _____ (ask) politely, I _____ (help) him. (First conditional).
- ▶ 9. If they _____ (not spend) so much money, they _____ (save) more. (Third conditional).
- ▶ 10. If I _____ (win) the lottery last year, I _____ (travel) around the world. (Third conditional).

Solution 5

- ▶ 1. If you **heat** (heat) water to 100°C, it **boils** (boil). (Zero conditional).
- ▶ 2. If she **studies** (study) harder, she **will pass** (pass) the exam. (First conditional).
- ▶ 3. If we **had left** (leave) earlier, we **wouldn't have missed** (not miss) the train. (Third conditional).

- ▶ 4. If she **had woken up** (wake up) on time, she **wouldn't have been** (not be) late for the meeting (Third conditional).
- ▶ 5. If you **press** (press) this button, the machine **starts** (start). (Zero conditional).
- ▶ 6. If we **don't hurry** (not hurry), we **will miss** (miss) the bus. (First conditional).
- ▶ 7. If I **knew** (know) his number, I **would call** (call) him. (Second conditional).
- ▶ 8. If he **asks** (ask) politely, I **will help** (help) him. (First conditional).
- ▶ 9. If they **hadn't spent** (not spend) so much money, they **would have saved** (save) more. (Third conditional).
- ▶ 10. If I **had won** (win) the lottery last year, I **would have travelled** (travel) around the world. (Third conditional).